

WEEK 10

CAN / CANNOT

Can is a modal verb.

Can is used to express **ability** or to say that something is **possible**.

Can is the same for all subjects. We don't add an 'S' in the third person (like other verbs)

The verb that comes after **Can** is in the infinitive without **to**:

- I **can** *speak* Spanish. (I have the ability to speak Spanish)
- He **can** *swim* well.
- We **can** see our neighbour in the garden.
- They **can** *play* the guitar.

Negative

To form the negative we add "**not**" after **can** to form one word: **cannot**.

We can also contract the negative to form **can't**. (can't = cannot)

- I **cannot** *play* the piano. We **can't** *go* to the cinema tonight.
- She **cannot** *speak* French very well. He **can't** *drive* a car.

Questions

To form the question we change the position of the subject and the auxiliary verb.

The main verb is still in the infinitive without *to*.

- **Can** you *speak* Japanese?
- **Can** she play the piano?
- Where **can** I buy an ice-cream?
- What **can** we *do* on Saturday?

Remember that you can use short answers:

- Can she ride a bike? **Yes, she can.**
- Can you speak Chinese? **No, I can't.**

CAN - CANNOT

USES OF CAN

- 1. ability or possibility**
- I can swim.
- 2. permission**
- You can use my pen.

CAN + VERB* *Base form of the infinitive

He can speak English. ✓

He can speaks English. ✗ No S

He can to speak English. ✗ No TO

AFFIRMATIVE

SINGULAR	I	can	speak English.
	You	can	ride a bike.
	He	can	drive a car.
	She	can	play the guitar.
	It	can	swim.

NEGATIVE

I	can't	speak French.
You	can't	ride a horse.
He	can't	drive a truck.
She	can't	play the piano.
It	can't	fly.

PLURAL	We	can	play football.
	You	can	see the stars.
	They	can	dance.

We	can't	play tennis.
You	can't	see germs.
They	can't	sing.

QUESTIONS

+ Affirmative They can speak Spanish.

? Question Can they speak Spanish?

Short Answer Yes, they can. / No, they can't.

CONTRACTION

can't = cannot

He can't sing.
= He cannot sing.

Exercises: Can / Can't

A. Complete the sentences with a verb from the box using can or can't.

find give open play speak understand

- I'm looking for my phone. I can't find it anywhere.
- When John travels in Spain and Italy, he talks to everyone because he _____ Spanish and Italian.
- Our classroom is locked. We _____ the door.
- I _____ a presentation about the moon.
I don't know anything about it.
- We _____ you. Please speak slowly.
- He's a good athlete. He _____ baseball and soccer well. He's on the baseball and soccer teams.

B. Match the halves of the dialogues.

- | | |
|---|--|
| <u>c</u> 1. Can Luisa dance? | a. No, I can't. It's hard to say it. |
| ___ 2. I can't understand this French phrase. | b. At the library. OK? |
| ___ 3. Can you pronounce this word? | c. No, but her sister can dance. |
| ___ 4. Can you play the guitar? | d. Yes. I can play the guitar and the piano. |
| ___ 5. Where can we meet? | e. <i>Au revoir</i> means good-bye. |
| ___ 6. Can Bob play soccer? | f. Oh, yes. He loves the game. |

C. Read the conversation. Use can or can't and the words in parentheses to complete it.

Debbie: It's very nice to meet you, Mr. Clark. Have a seat, please.

Gene: Thank you. It's very nice to meet you, too.

Debbie: Your résumé looks very impressive. 1. _____
(I/ask) you just a few questions?

Gene: Of course. What would you like to know?

Debbie: 2. _____ (you/speak) Spanish? Many of our
students speak Spanish.

Gene: Unfortunately, I 3. _____ (not/speak) Spanish very
well.

Debbie: That's OK. And 4. _____ (you/write) lesson plans?

Gene: Yes, I can. I learned that on my previous job.

Debbie: Wonderful. 5. _____ (you/coach) any sports?

Gene: Yes, I can.

Debbie: 6. _____ (what sports/you/coach)?

Gene: Soccer and track.

Debbie: And here's my last question: 7. _____
(you/teach) summer school?

Gene: I am sorry, but I 8. _____ (not / teach) summer
school. I travel in the summer.

MUST / MUSTN'T

We can use '**must**' to talk about rules. For the negative, we can say '**must not**' or '**mustn't**'.

Parents **must take** care of their children.

You **mustn't shout** in the library.

She **must not forget** her books.

The main verb is without '**to**'.

You **must look** both ways when crossing the road. (NOT You ~~must to look~~ both ways when crossing the road.)

We **mustn't run** in school. (NOT We ~~mustn't to run~~ in school.)

Children **must respect** their parents. (NOT Children ~~must respecting~~ their parents.)

We don't use '**must**' in question form.

We don't say: ~~Must she get up early?~~

Exercises: Must and Mustn't

A. Find the mistake, underline it and write the correct sentence.

- a. I must to tidy my bedroom.
- b. We mustn't making a mess.
- c. You mustn't respect your teacher.
- d. You mustn't to forget my birthday!
- e. My brother must doing his homework.

B. Read the rules and write the letter of the rule under the correct picture.

- a. You must be on time.
- b. You must listen to the teacher.
- c. You mustn't use your phone in class.
- d. You mustn't run in the corridors.
- e. You must do your homework.

				

C. Circle True or False.

- | | | |
|---|-------------|--------------|
| a. You must pay attention at school. | <i>True</i> | <i>False</i> |
| b. You must be quiet in the library. | <i>True</i> | <i>False</i> |
| c. You mustn't wear trainers when you do sport. | <i>True</i> | <i>False</i> |
| d. You must shout at the museum. | <i>True</i> | <i>False</i> |
| e. You mustn't run across the road. | <i>True</i> | <i>False</i> |

D. Write must or mustn't in the sentences.

1. You tidy up your room.
2. You smoke.
3. You do your homework.
4. You play with fire.
5. You be home on time.